



SCHOOL OF PHYSICAL THERAPY

Physical Therapy Common Terms & Abbreviations

- PT – Physical Therapy / Physical Therapist
- PTA – Physical Therapist Assistant
- OT – Occupational Therapy
- SLP – Speech-Language Pathologist
- PM&R – Physical Medicine & Rehabilitation
- H&P – History & Physical (medical exam)
- Dx – Diagnosis
- Tx – Treatment
- Rx – Prescription
- Sx – Symptoms
- Hx – History
- Fx – Fracture

Assessment & Documentation

- ROM – Range of Motion
- PROM – Passive Range of Motion
- AROM – Active Range of Motion
- AAROM – Active Assisted Range of Motion
- MMT – Manual Muscle Testing
- BP – Blood Pressure
- HR – Heart Rate
- RR – Respiratory Rate
- O2 Sat – Oxygen Saturation
- ADLs – Activities of Daily Living
- IADLs – Instrumental Activities of Daily Living
- SOAP – Subjective, Objective, Assessment, Plan (documentation format)
- WNL – Within Normal Limits
- WFL – Within Functional Limits

Treatment & Interventions



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- TherEx – Therapeutic Exercise
- NMRE – Neuromuscular Re-education
- STM – Soft Tissue Mobilization
- NDT – Neuro-Developmental Treatment
- PNF – Proprioceptive Neuromuscular Facilitation
- CPM – Continuous Passive Motion (machine-assisted movement)
- E-stim – Electrical Stimulation
- TENS – Transcutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation
- FES – Functional Electrical Stimulation
- US – Ultrasound therapy
- HEP – Home Exercise Program

Mobility & Assistive Devices

- AD – Assistive Device
- LBQC – Large Base Quad Cane
- SBQC – Small Base Quad Cane
- Loftstrand – Forearm crutches
- WC – Wheelchair
- TTWB – Toe-Touch Weight Bearing
- PWB – Partial Weight Bearing
- WBAT – Weight Bearing As Tolerated
- NWB – Non-Weight Bearing

Conditions & Diagnoses

- LBP – Low Back Pain
- OA – Osteoarthritis
- RA – Rheumatoid Arthritis
- DJD – Degenerative Joint Disease
- SCI – Spinal Cord Injury
- CVA – Cerebrovascular Accident (Stroke)
- TBI – Traumatic Brain Injury
- MS – Multiple Sclerosis



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- PD – Parkinson's Disease
- CP – Cerebral Palsy
- ALS – Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis
- MD – Muscular Dystrophy
- RTC – Rotator Cuff Tear
- ACL – Anterior Cruciate Ligament
- PCL – Posterior Cruciate Ligament
- MCL – Medial Collateral Ligament
- LCL – Lateral Collateral Ligament

Other Common PT Notes

- HOB – Head of Bed
- BKA – Below Knee Amputation
- AKA – Above Knee Amputation
- CPM – Continuous Passive Motion
- SBA – Stand-By Assist
- CGA – Contact Guard Assist
- Mod A – Moderate Assistance
- Max A – Maximal Assistance
- PRN – As Needed
- BID – Twice Daily
- TID – Three Times Daily
- QID – Four Times Daily

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